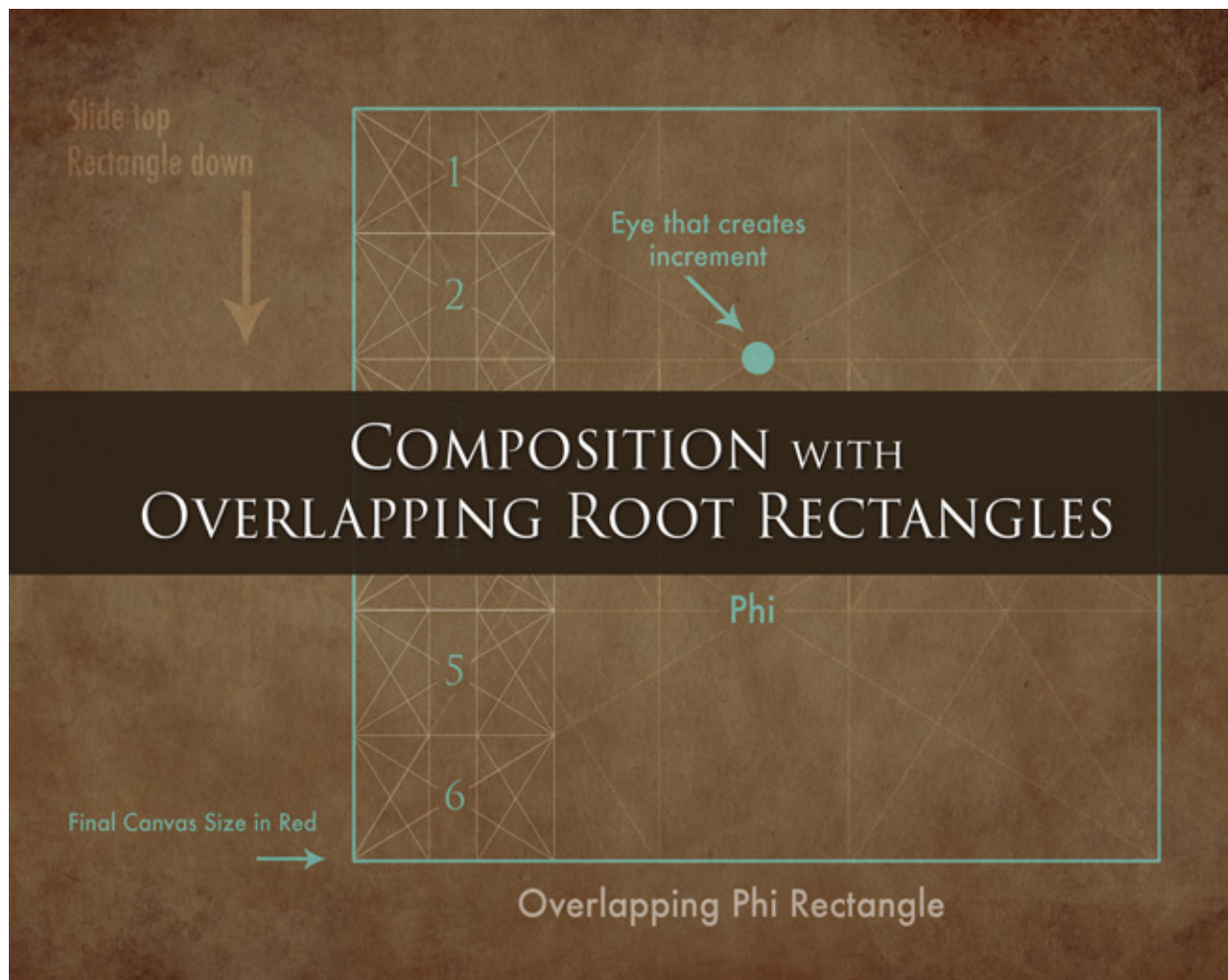


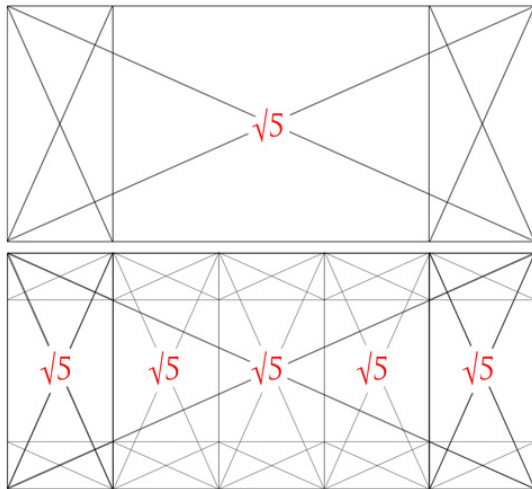


Hi everyone, welcome back! Much love for all of the continued support. I can't tell you how much I appreciate all of the great emails, comments, and gratitude I receive every day. Today we are going to cover a topic that sparked my interest ever since I analyzed a Klimt painting (see [#404](#)). He composed a painting with **multiple phi rectangles**, but I couldn't figure out how he came to use that specific grid. Well, today I show you how he did it! It's all about properly **overlapping** the armature of rectangles to get the desired size of a specific canvas or fine art photograph. I break down this complex **composition** tool with plenty of diagrams and explanations that will allow you to **simply** apply it to your art. Let's get into it!

Dynamic Symmetry (see [Day 14](#)) can get very in-depth, and we can use all of it's intricacies to our advantage. We've already covered **compound root rectangles** (see [Day 155](#)), and we've mentioned **overlapping root rectangles**, so this should be nothing new. What is new, is the complete understanding of how to properly use and apply them.

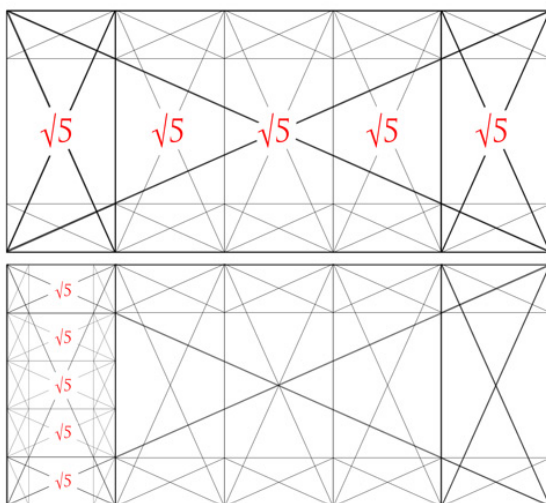
Overlapping the **armature** (see [Day 14](#)) of rectangles in a simple (and correct) way was never taught to me...it was mentioned in my studies with **Myron Barnstone**, but it was never taught how to properly overlap. It's something I had to discover on my own, and I'm glad the mystery is somewhat solved. It always seemed to be a sloppy way to compose, and I knew that the master

painters wouldn't incorporate a sloppy technique into their workflow. Thankfully, overlapping the armature can be simplified by first understanding how root rectangles work. It's really simple. Each root rectangle **breaks down** into the exact number of rectangles within the mother rectangle. Once the line for the reciprocal is dropped, it completes a smaller root 5. For example, a Root 5 rectangle consists of five root 5's as seen below.



Five Root 5 Rectangles within the mother rectangle

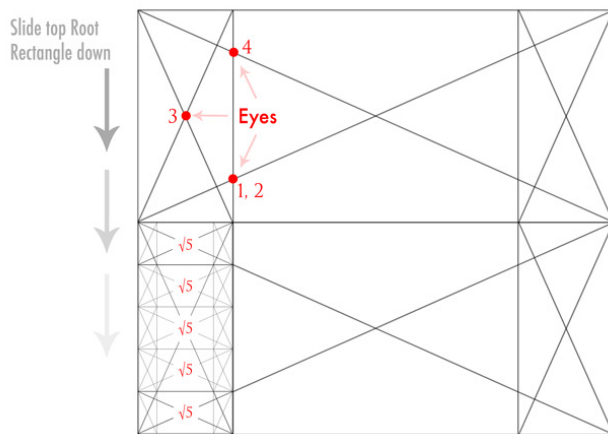
We can continue to break down these root 5 rectangles as seen in the next diagram. If all of the grids were in place, we'd see a total of **25 smaller root 5's**. It doesn't stop there! You could continue breaking it down if you needed for a painting or fine art photo.



Breaking the Root 5 down further

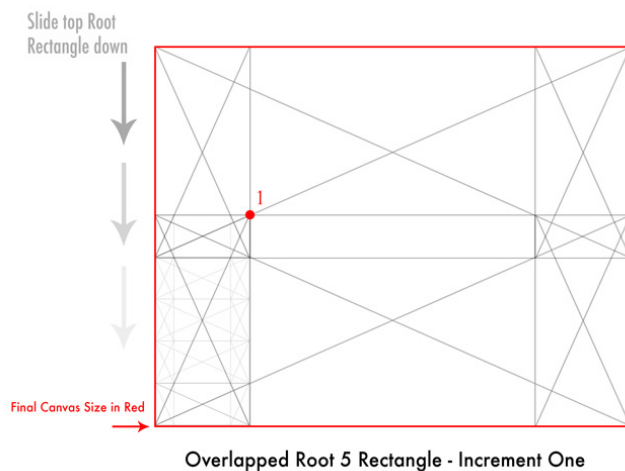
Breaking down root rectangles in order to overlap them is **simplest** when using the set of smaller root 5's as a guide for each **increment**. We don't have to draw all of these out thankfully. We can use the **eyes** (intersection points) to help us find these increments. In the diagram below, we can see two root 5 rectangles with the basic armature (one on top of the other). The eyes (1, 2, 3, 4) of the top root 5 will intersect the bottom root five as we slide the rectangle down.

Note: Photoshop is our friend these days, and it's easy to slide a rectangle down onto another...back in the day though, they probably could've used tracing paper to make this easier for them.



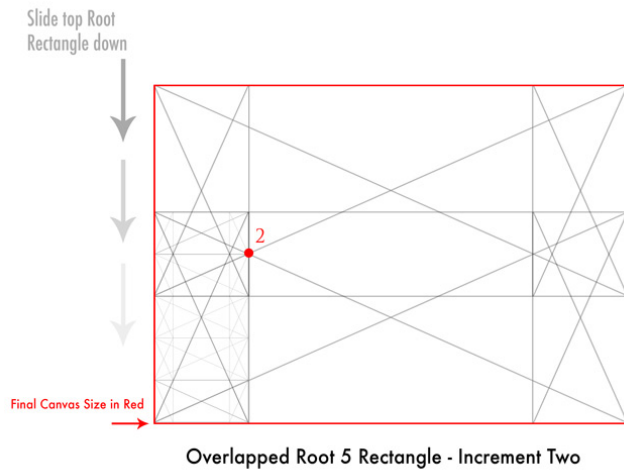
Use the **Eyes** (Intersection points) to create Overlapping Increments

As we slide the top root 5 down, we'll get our first incremental point. Where the "1" intersects the top line of the lower root 5. The outer red rectangle is the final canvas size. We can use this technique to design a specific size for our fine art photography as well.

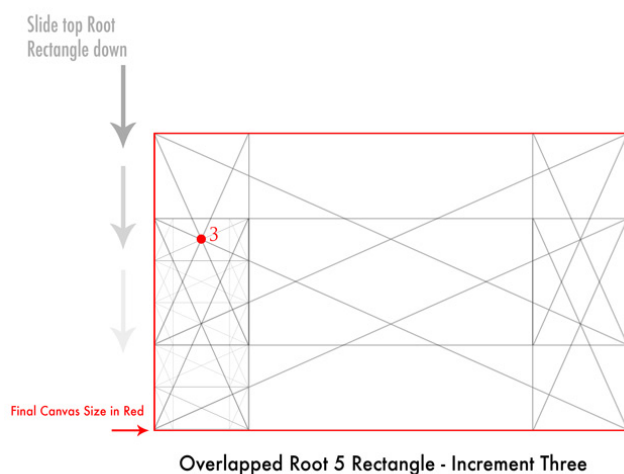


Overlapped Root 5 Rectangle - Increment One

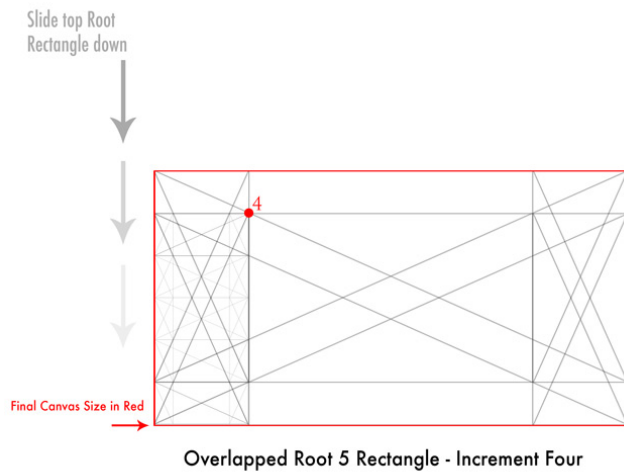
Slide the top root 5 down further and we see that the same point intersects again at the major sinister diagonal of the lower root 5 rectangle. This creates our second incremental point. The nice thing about overlapping in this fashion is that we get an *equal* amount of root rectangles across the final canvas size...we'll see this in action soon when we take a look at Klimt's painting.



Sliding the top down further to get our third increment for overlapping the root 5 in a **clean** and **proper** method.



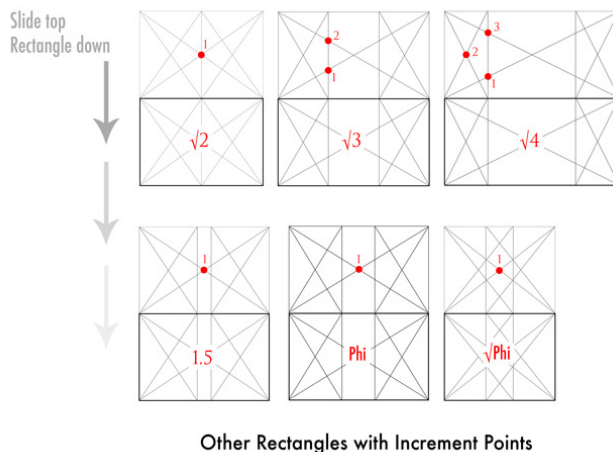
Here we have our fourth increment and another canvas size that can be used...taking full advantage of the dynamic symmetry present.



Other Root Rectangles

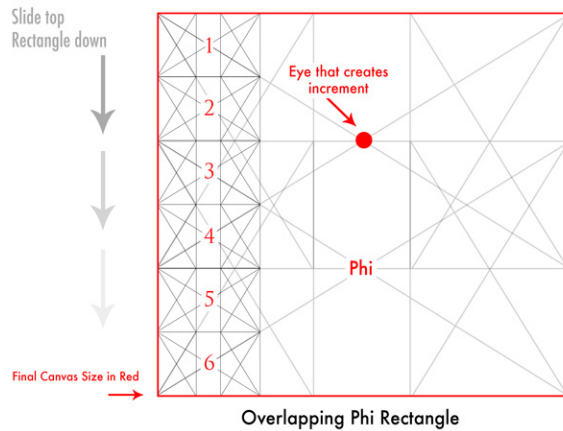
The other root rectangles, 1.5, phi, and root phi work in a similar fashion. The root 2 only has one intersection point that helps us create an overlapping root 2 canvas size. Remember, the intersection points are the key to creating an *equal* amount of smaller root rectangles across the final canvas size. Other points can be used, but they won't create an equal amount while still using the intersection points.

The root 3 has two intersection points, and the root 4 has three. The other rectangles, 1.5, phi, and root phi, which aren't root rectangles only have one intersecting point that creates a properly overlapped rectangle. We'll take a closer look at the phi rectangle next.



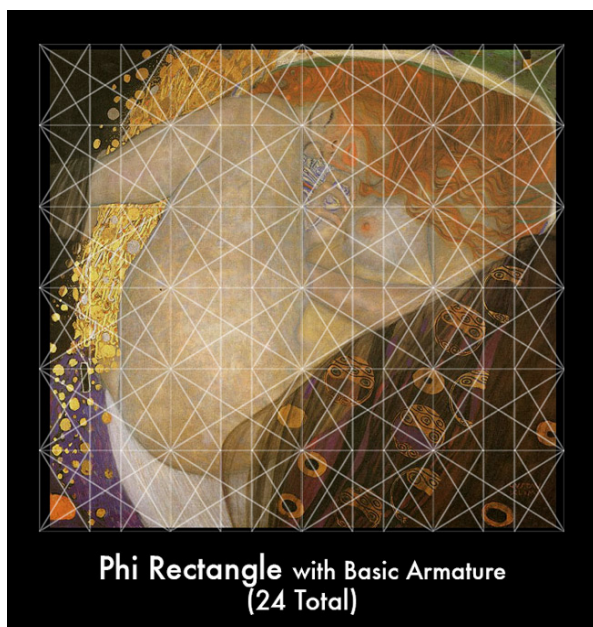
Overlapping Phi Rectangle

Here we can see when we move the top phi rectangle down (which is seen in the above diagram) we get an equal amount of smaller phi rectangles in the final canvas size. So, how do we apply this to our **art**?



We can use [Klimt](#) as an example to see how we use this in our paintings or fine art photography. If you had a chance to check out the article on him (see [#404](#)), you'll recognize the painting below.

We discovered that he used a total of **24 small phi rectangles** to compose his painting, but I wasn't sure how he would know how to do this. It's simple, now that we understand how to properly overlap rectangles. He overlapped two phi rectangles in the same way we did above. He probably used tracing paper to do this, instead of Photoshop, but the method still remains.



That's it, easy right?! Simply overlap your rectangles by using specific eyes within the basic armature. Use this overlapping method to take advantage of the power of dynamic symmetry, while also creating a custom canvas size with an equal amount of rectangles within it. I hope that gives you more confidence when overlapping rectangles. If you have questions, please comment below and I will do my best to help. See you next time!